

of curated learning resources built by an international community of educators, researchers and learners.

- NROER (<https://nroer.gov.in/welcome>) is the National Repository of Open Educational Resources. It is an excellent initiative from the government of India. It provides open educational resources mapped to school curricula, an e-library, e-books and e-courses.

In addition to NROER, there are other great initiatives from the Indian government to promote technology aided learning. Some of them are shown in Table 1.

Learning management systems (LMS)

As stated in the beginning of this article, there is a need for coordinating all the tasks associated with remote learning. Learning management systems (LMS) enable you to do this. There are many choices in open source LMSs, as listed below:

- Moodle (<https://moodle.org/>)
- ILIAS (<https://www.ilias.de/en/>)
- SAKAI (<https://www.sakailms.org/>)
- OpenOLAT (<https://www.openolat.com/?lang=en>)
- ATutor (<https://atutor.github.io/>)

In addition to these, there are certain popular options available in freemium mode such as Edmodo, Google Classroom, etc. The choice of the LMS depends on various factors such as platform support, learner category, types of features required, SCORM compliance, etc.

Inclusion is the key

We need to do everything possible to include every learner when we are delivering learning content using ICT tools.

- There are a standard set of guidelines for building resources, which can be accessed by persons with disabilities. Make sure to follow the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) to make your online

Initiative	URL
CEC (Consortium for Educational Communication) (Swayam, Swayam Prabha and NME-ICT are pioneering projects from CEC)	http://cec.nic.in/cec/
ePathshala	http://epathshala.nic.in/
NPTEL	https://nptel.ac.in/
Curricula for ICT in education	https://ictcurriculum.gov.in/

Table 1

resources accessible to students with disabilities.

- If some learners are facing difficulties in accessing video resources due to the lack of stable network access, then we should provide resources in alternate mediums such as in text form or audio (which might be delivered using less bandwidth). Of course, there are still many other challenges that would require detailed research before providing solutions.

There are plenty of other tools that have not been listed in this article. Enumerating all of them is neither possible in this article nor required. In my opinion, learning to use the tools is important but what is even more crucial is the ability to adapt to the current scenario. The skillsets required for remote learning are quite different from those needed for the live in-person teaching scenario. For example,

an important element of classroom management involves the use of visual and non-visual cues such as gauging the facial expressions of students, assessing the mood of the class, etc. In remote learning, when we present content as recorded material, teachers cannot make use of these important feedback cues which makes teaching more challenging. With the ongoing COVID-19 pandemic, no one is sure how long social distancing will need to be enforced or whether it is going to become the new normal.

This is certainly an enormous challenge to academia. So it would be wise to convert this challenge into an opportunity to evolve a new ecosystem for teaching-learning. The most important thing is a change in mindset and the willingness to learn, unlearn and relearn among all the stakeholders, to deliver uninterrupted education to the next generation. **END** 

References

These links are in addition to those provided in the body of the article itself.

- [1] Beamer, <https://ctan.org/pkg/beamer?lang=en>
- [2] mpress, <https://www.libreoffice.org/discover/impress/>
- [3] Reveal.js, <https://revealjs.com/#/>
- [4] mpress.js, <https://github.com/impress/impress.js>
- [5] FreeMind, http://freemind.sourceforge.net/wiki/index.php/Main_Page
- [6] Freeplane, <https://www.freeplane.org/wiki/index.php/Home>
- [7] XMind, <https://www.xmind.net/>
- [8] OBS, <https://obsproject.com/>
- [9] Audacity, <https://www.audacityteam.org/>

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